



Flat design goes well with fewer, simpler colours.

would have to be “clean”. A good choice of typefaces is crucial to ensure high readability. It’s an unwritten rule of flat design that serif fonts are a strict no-no. The slight projections at the edges of the letters go against the “function over form” idea of flat design. They are considered a distraction. Instead, flat design happily embraces fonts having clean-cut lines. Helvetica, developed in 1957, is a popular choice of typeface among websites that use flat design. Helvetica’s most striking feature is the fact that all the terminal edges of its letters are all either horizontal or vertical – a feature that perfectly aligns with the De Stijl ideals.

Flat design’s obsession with clarity and simplicity extends to its choice of colours. Dropbox’s homepage greets you with a peaceful combination of blue and white. Google Play Music spreads across your tablet’s display with energetic orange. Here, the key again is to reduce distractions and provide a uniform, consistent experience. Most designs use not more than three colours. Some websites even choose to go for a single colour palette, with clever use of whitespace and one or two different levels of saturation to create distinctions between design elements.